

GUWAHATI

A Brief on the city:

Guwahati is a major city in Eastern India. Dispur is the capital of Assam state.

Guwahati is a mixture of beautiful landmark and fast growing developing city in India. It is a major commercial and educational center, world class institutions such as the Indian Institute of Technology Guwahati. This city is a major center for sports and other activities of north east peoples and for the administrative and political activities in Assam.

2. Education:

Major Central/State Universities in Guwahati comprises of 1. Assam Rajiv Gandhi University of Co-operative Management, 2. Assam Science & Technology University, 3. Cotton College State University, 4. Guwahati University, 5. Krishna Kanta Handique State Open University, 6. National Law University and Judicial Academy, 7. Srimanta Sankaradeva University of Health Sciences.

3. Culture and Tourism:

Many South, Eastern and Southeast Asian communities have settled in Assam over the centuries. But civilisation in the region did not necessarily begin with the fertile Brahmaputra Valley. Discoveries of stone implements and pottery reveal the existence of prehistoric communities on the highlands encircling the valley. Anthropological accounts say Assam's demography is marked by several waves of migration. Australoids, the first inhabitants, were absorbed or dispersed by the Mongoloids that ancient Sanskrit literature term as Kirats. The Caucasoids followed, and their four categories – Mediterranean, Alpine, Indo-Aryan and Irano-Scythian – settled in the valleys.

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GOA

A Brief on the city:

Goa, a tiny emerald land on the west coast of India, is the state of the Union states of India. Boundaries of Goa State are defined in the North Terekhol river which separates it from Maharashtra, in the East and South by Karnataka State and West by Arabian Sea.

2. Education:

Goa University, established in June 1985 by an Act of Goa Government, is located on a picturesque campus spread over 427.49 acres area of Taleigao Plateau overlooking the Zuari Estuary, within close vicinity of the capital city of Panaji, in North Goa. Besides being the most important location for post-graduate studies, it also serves as the academic nerve-centre of the higher education system in Goa. Today Goa University, is a university of affiliated colleges, 55 of which are distributed across Goa, 30 in general education, 25 in professional education. Presently, Goa University has 12 faculties of which 6 faculties operate on the campus with 24 Departments and 3 Research Centers that offer post-graduate education in the State of Goa.

Goa enjoys a place of pride in the country as one of the most literate states of India.

3. Culture and Tourism:

The state of Goa, in India, is famous for its beaches and places of worship. Tourism is its primary industry. Tourism is generally focused on the coastal areas of Goa. Foreign tourists, mostly from Europe, arrive in Goa in winter whilst the summer and monsoon seasons see a large number of Indian tourists.

Major tourist attractions include: Bom Jesus Basilica, Fort Aguada, a wax museum on Indian culture and a heritage museum. The Churches and Convents of Goa have been declared a World Heritage Site by UNESCO.

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CHENNAI

A Brief on the city:

Chennai is the capital city of the State of Tamilnadu. The district city is one of the metropolis of India and serves as the gateway of the culture of South India. In spite of being the capital of a Tamil speaking State, it has emerged as cosmopolitan city playing an important role in the historical, cultural and intellectual development of India, representing still the distinct components of the highest form of Dravidian civilisation. In addition, it holds out an interesting fare of South Indian architecture, music, dance, drama, sculpture and other arts and crafts. Chennai is situated on the north-east end of Tamil Nadu on the coast of Bay of Bengal.

2. Education:

Major Central/State Universities in Chennai comprises of 1. Anna University, 2. Madras University, 3. Tamil Nadu Music and Fine Arts University, 4. Tamil Nadu Open University, 5. Tamil Nadu Teacher Education University, 6. Tamilnadu Dr. M.G.R.Medical University, 7. Tamilnadu Physical Education and Sports University, 8. Tamilnadu Veterinary & Animal Sciences University

3. Culture and Tourism:

The doorway to South India, Chennai is a miraculous gift the land of Tamil Nadu embraces. Drawing the quality of 'Unity in Diversity' from the homeland country India, Chennai carries the legacy of rich cultural heritage imbibed in its fine arts, music and dance forms, people and cuisines. The attribute of being a cosmopolitan city, Chennai mirrors confluence of all the diverse cultures nourishing within its boundaries. The residents of the city living in sheer harmony with each other confirm that the varied culture exists. The festivals colour Chennai in the fun and fervour of the celebrations. A number of monuments silently express the glorious history of the city they witnessed, the traditional art forms they preserved and continued to keep it alive. The spirit of Chennai, vibrant culture and reminiscent traditions all make the city wonderful and tremendously important as a part of Indian heritage.

The capital city and metropolis Chennai is no less than a wonder to explore when it comes to language. Multiple people, hailing from diverse backgrounds lead to the flow of many languages within the territory of Chennai. Tamil enjoys the status of being the prime language in the city.

When it comes to hospitality and traditional food, Chennai beats many of the cities easily. As serving food is seen as an utmost pious deed in the entire South India, get ready to experience unforgettable moments while dining in the land of Chennai. They serve number of traditional foodstuffs including sambhar, dosa, idli, rasam, coconut chutney, dry curry and kootu etc with steamed rice on banana leaf, which is the traditional way of dining in Chennai. The city has multiple variants of cuisines for vegan as well as for non-vegetarians. Do not forget to taste the rich Tamilian filtered coffee.

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CHANDIGARH

A Brief on the city:

Chandigarh, was planned by the famous French architect Le Corbusier. Picturesquely located at the foothills of Shivaliks, it is known as one of the best experiments in urban planning and modern architecture in the twentieth century in India.

The deity 'Chandi', the goddess of power gave the city its name "Chandigarh. The city assumed the unique distinction of being the capital city of both, Punjab and Haryana while it itself was declared as a Union Territory.

2. Education:

Punjab University is state university in Chandigarh. The colleges run courses in Arts, Commerce, Science, Computer Education, Biotechnology, Information Technology and Business Administration. Three of these colleges have postgraduate courses in Information Technology, Economics, English, Public Administration, Commerce, Music Instrumental, Music Vocal and Dance. Besides, a number of job oriented subjects such as Functional English, Functional Hindi, Principles and Practices of Insurance and Advertising, Sales Promotion and Sales Management are also available in these colleges.

The college libraries are well stocked with books and journals to equip the students to keep pace with the latest information and knowledge.

3. Culture and Tourism:

Chandigarh is the best-planned city in India, with architecture which is world-renowned, and a quality of life, which is unparalleled. As the capital of the states of Punjab and Haryana, and the Union Territory of Chandigarh it is a prestigious city.

Serenity and a city are two diametrically opposite concepts, which however, get belied in the 'City Beautiful'. Chandigarh is a rare epitome of modernization co-existing with nature's preservation. It is here that the trees and plants are as much a part of the construction plans as the buildings and the roads. India's first planned city, is a rich, prosperous, spic and span, green city rightly called " THE CITY BEAUTIFUL ".

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BHUBANESWAR

A Brief on the city:

Bhubaneswar, the capital of the Indian state of Odisha. It is the largest city in Odisha and is a centre of economic and religious importance in Eastern India.

Along with the old town, the region of Bhubaneswar, historically was often depicted as Ekamra Kshetra. With the diverse ranges of heritage resources, it showcases significant sacred cultural landscape components which have evolved with the support of available natural resource base and cultural trigger.

The history of the areas in and around the present-day city can be traced to ancient time. With many 8th-12th century CE Hindu temples, which span the entire spectrum of Kalinga architecture, Bhubaneswar is often referred to as a "Temple City of India". With Puri and Konark it forms the Swarna Tribhuja ("Golden Triangle"), one of eastern India's most visited destinations.

Bhubaneswar and Cuttack are often referred to as the 'twin cities of Odisha'. An emerging information technology (IT) and education hub, Bhubaneswar is one of the country's fastest-developing cities.

2. Education:

Utkal University, is the oldest, with many affiliated general colleges, law colleges, medical and pharmacy colleges. Orissa University of Agriculture and Technology established in 1962, is the second oldest agricultural university in the country. Utkal University of Culture is dedicated for research, teaching and education.

Bhubaneswar has a large number of institutes for higher education. Bhubaneswar is one of the few cities in India which houses IIT, NISER, and many other premier Government institutes. Premier educational institutions include the IIT Bhubaneswar, National Institute of Science Education and Research, International Institute of Information Technology, Bhubaneswar (IIIT-Bh), Xavier Institute of Management (XIMB), Institute of Mathematics and Applications (IOMA), National Institute of Fashion Technology, Institute of Physics, Institute of Life Sciences, Institute of Minerals and Materials Technology, Central Institute of Freshwater Aquaculture, Regional Medical Research Center and Regional Institute of Education. The premiere Engineering college owned by the state Government of Odisha, College of Engineering and Technology, Bhubaneswar, is the most comprehensive engineering Institute in the capital having a set of specialisation which include, electrical engineering, architecture, textile, and fashion technology, etc. The Central Institute of Plastics Engineering and Technology located in Bhubaneswar is a unique Institute owned by Government of India. Rama Devi Women's University is a University located in Bhubaneswar which is specifically dedicated for imparting education to women.

3. Culture and Tourism:

Bhubaneswar is supposed to have had over one thousand temples, earning the tag of the 'Temple City of India'. Temples are made in the Kalinga architectural style with

a pine spire that curves up to a point over the sanctum housing the presiding deity and a pyramid-covered hall where people sit and pray.

Famous temples include Lingaraj Temple, Muktesvara Temple, Rajarani Temple, Ananta Vasudeva Temple.

The twin hills of Khandagiri & Udayagiri, served as the site of an ancient Jain monastery which was carved into cave-like chambers in the face of the hill. Dhauli hills has major edicts of Ashoka engraved on a mass of rock.

Bhubaneswar along with Cuttack is the home of the Oriya cinema industry, where most of the state's film studios are. Odia culture survives in the form of Classical Odissi dance, handicrafts, sand artistry and sculpturing as well as theatre and music. Odissi, the oldest of the eight surviving classical dance forms of India can be traced from archaeological evidence from the temples in Bhubaneswar.

As a part of the Ekamra Festival, many cultural sub-festivals takes place in January in Bhubaneswar which includes Kalinga Mahotsav (for traditional martial arts), Dhauli-Kalinga Mahotsav (for classical dance forms), Rajarani Music Festival (for classical music) and Mukteswar Dance Festival (for Odishi dance). Residents engage in khattis, or leisurely chats, that often take the form of freestyle intellectual conversation.

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BHOPAL

A Brief on the city:

Bhopal is the capital of the Indian state of Madhya Pradesh and the administrative headquarters of Bhopal district and Bhopal division. Bhopal is known as the City of Lakes for its various natural as well as artificial lakes and is also one of the greenest cities in India.

Bhopal houses various institutions and installations of national importance, including ISRO's Master Control Facility and BHEL. Bhopal is home to the largest number of Institutes of National Importance in India, namely Indian Institute of Science Education and Research Bhopal (IISER), Maulana Azad National Institute of Technology Bhopal (MANIT), School of Planning and Architecture Bhopal (SPA), and All India Institute of Medical Sciences, Bhopal (AIIMS).

Bhopal has been selected as one of the first twenty Indian cities to be developed as a smart city under PM Narendra Modi's flagship Smart Cities Mission and will be the first smart city of India in coming years.

2. Education:

The Bhopal is the home of many universities and national Institutes. The institutes and universities headquartered in the city include: 1. Atal Bihari Vajpayee Hindi Vishwavidyalaya, 2. Barkatullaah University, 3. M.P.Bhoj (open) University, 4. Makhanlal Chaturvedi National University of Journalism & Communication, 5. National Law Institute University, 6. Rajiv Gandhi Prodyogiki Vishwavidyalaya, 7. Sanchi University of Buddhist-Indic Studies.

3. Culture and Tourism:

Bharat Bhavan is the main cultural centre of the city. It has an art gallery, an open-air amphitheatre facing the Upper Lake, two other theatres and a tribal museum.

Diwali and Eid are major festivals in Bhopal. Diwali is celebrated by worshiping the wealth goddess Lakshmi. Eid is special to the city as all the Hindus take time out to visit their Muslim friends and greet them and get treated with delicacies, the speciality of the day being sweet sewaiya. Bhopali culture is such that both Hindus and Muslims visit each other on their respective festivals to greet and exchange sweets. During Ganesh puja and Durga Puja (Navratras), idols of Ganesh and Durga are established in jhankis throughout the city. People throng to offer prayers to their deities. At the end of Navratras, on the day of Vijayadashami (or Dussehra), huge effigies of Ravan are burnt in different parts of the city. Some of them are organised by the local administration and stand as tall as 60 feet (18 m).

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BANGALORE

A Brief on the city:

Bangalore known as **Bengaluru** is the capital of the Indian state of Karnataka. Located in southern India on the Deccan Plateau, at a height of over 900 m (3,000 ft) above sea level. Its elevation is the highest among the major cities of India.

A succession of South Indian dynasties, the Western Gangas, the Cholas and the Hoysalas, ruled the present region of Bangalore until in 1537 CE, Kempé Gowdā – a feudal ruler under the Vijayanagara Empire – established a mud fort considered to be the foundation of modern Bangalore. Following India's independence in 1947, Bangalore became the capital of Mysore State, and remained capital when the new Indian state of Karnataka was formed in 1956. The two urban settlements of Bangalore – city and cantonment – which had developed as independent entities merged into a single urban centre in 1949. The existing Kannada name, *Bengaluru*, was declared the official name of the city in 2006.

Bangalore is sometimes referred to as the "Silicon Valley of India" (or "IT capital of India") because of its role as the nation's leading information technology (IT) exporter. Indian technological organisations ISRO, Infosys, Wipro and HAL are headquartered in the city.

2. Education:

Bangalore University, established in 1886, provides affiliation to over 500 colleges, with a total student enrolment exceeding 300,000. The university has two campuses within Bangalore – Jnanabharathi and Central College. University Visvesvaraya College of Engineering was established in the year 1917, by Bharat Ratna Sir M. Visvesvaraya, at present, the UVCE is the only engineering college under the Bangalore University. Bangalore also has many private Engineering Colleges affiliated to Visvesvaraya Technological University.

3. Culture and Tourism:

Bangalore is known as the "Garden City of India" because of its gentle climate, broad streets, greenery and the presence of many public parks, such as Lal Bagh and Cubbon Park. Bangalore is sometimes called as the "Rock/Metal Capital of India" because of its underground music scene and it is one of the premier places to hold international rock concerts. In May 2012, Lonely Planet ranked Bangalore 3rd among the world's top 10 cities to visit.

Bangalore is also home to many vegan-friendly restaurants and vegan activism groups due to which it has been named as India's most vegan-friendly city by PETA India.

Biannual flower shows are held at the Lal Bagh Gardens during the week of Republic Day (26 January) and Independence Day (15 August). Bangalore Karaga or "Karaga Shaktiyotsava" is one of the most important and oldest festivals of Bangalore dedicated to the Hindu Goddess Draupadi. It is celebrated annually by the Thigala community, over a period of nine days in the month of March or April. The Someshwara Car festival is an annual procession of the idol of the Halasuru Someshwara Temple (Ulsoor) led by the Vokkaligas, a farming community in southern Karnataka, occurring in April. Karnataka Rajyotsava is widely

celebrated on 1 November and is a public holiday in the city, to mark the formation of Karnataka state on 1 November 1956. Other popular festivals in Bangalore are Ugadi, Ram Navami, Eid ul-Fitr, Ganesh Chaturthi, St. Mary's feast, Dasara, Deepawali and Christmas.

The diversity of cuisine is reflective of the social and economic diversity of Bangalore. Bangalore has a wide and varied mix of restaurant types and cuisines and Bangaloreans deem eating out as an intrinsic part of their culture. Roadside vendors, tea stalls, and South Indian, North Indian, Chinese and Western fast food are all very popular in the city. Udupi restaurants are very popular and serve predominantly vegetarian, regional cuisine.

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AHMEDABAD

A Brief on the city:

Ahmedabad also known as Amdavad in Gujarati is the largest city and former capital of Gujarat state in India. It is the administrative headquarters of the Ahmedabad district and the seat of the Gujarat High Court. Ahmedabad is located on the banks of the Sabarmati River, 30 km (19 mi) from the state capital Gandhinagar, which is its twin city.

Ahmedabad has been selected as one of the hundred Indian cities to be developed as a smart city under PM Narendra Modi's flagship Smart Cities.

2. Education:

A large number of colleges in the city are affiliated with Gujarat University; Gujarat Technological University.

Other educational institutions in Ahmedabad include the Indian Institute of Management Ahmedabad, the Gujarat National Law University, the National Institute of Design, the Pandit Deendayal Petroleum University, the Gujarat National Law University, Entrepreneurship Development Institute of India.

3. Culture and Tourism:

Ahmedabad observes a wide range of festivals. Popular celebrations and observances include Uttarayan, an annual kite-flying day on 14 and 15 January. Nine nights of Navratri are celebrated with people performing Garba, the most popular folk dance of Gujarat, at venues across the city. The festival of lights, Deepavali, is celebrated with the lighting of lamps in every house, decorating the floors with rangoli, and the lighting of firecrackers. The annual Rath Yatra procession on the *Ashadh-sud-bij* date of the Hindu calendar at the Jagannath Temple and the procession of *Tajia* during the Muslim holy month of Muharram are important events.

One of the most popular forms of meal in Ahmedabad is a typical Gujarati *thali* which was first served commercially by Chandvilas Hotel in 1900. It consists of roti (Chapati), dal, rice and *shaak* (cooked vegetables, sometimes with curry), with accompaniments of pickles and roasted *papads*. Beverages include buttermilk and tea; sweet dishes include laddoo, mango, and vedhmi. *Dhoklas*, *theplas* and *dhebras* are also very popular dishes in Ahmedabad.

Parts of Ahmedabad are known for their folk art. The artisans of Rangeela *pol* make tie-dyed *bandhunis*, while the cobbler shops of Madhupura sell traditional *mojdi* (also known as *mojri*) footwear. Idols of Ganesha and other religious icons are made in huge numbers in the Gulbai Tekra area. The shops at the Law Garden sell mirror work handicraft.

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HYDERABAD

A Brief on the city:

Hyderabad is the capital of the southern Indian state of Telangana situated along the banks of the Musi River. Much of Hyderabad is situated on hilly terrain around artificial lakes, including Hussain Sagar—predating the city's founding.

The city of smiles, of lights, of a thousand faces, endearingly called the Pearl City, Hyderabad offers a variety of tourist attractions ranging from Heritage monuments, Lakes and Parks, Gardens and Resorts, Museums to delectable cuisine and a delightful shopping experience. To the traveller, Hyderabad offers a fascinating panorama of the past, with a richly mixed cultural and historical tradition spanning 400 colourful years.

2. Education:

Many of professional graduation colleges in Hyderabad, are affiliated with either Jawaharlal Nehru Technological University Hyderabad (JNTUH) or Osmania University (OU).

There are six state universities and three central universities in Hyderabad. The central universities are the University of Hyderabad, Maulana Azad National Urdu University and the English and Foreign Languages University. Osmania University, established in 1918, was the first university in Hyderabad and as of 2012 is India's second most popular institution for international students. The Dr. B. R. Ambedkar Open University, established in 1982, is the first distance-learning Open University in India.

Hyderabad is also home to a number of centres specializing in particular fields such as biomedical sciences, biotechnology and pharmaceuticals, such as the National Institute of Pharmaceutical Education and Research (NIPER) and National Institute of Nutrition (NIN). Hyderabad has five major medical schools - Osmania Medical College, Gandhi Medical College, Nizam's Institute of Medical Sciences, Deccan College of Medical Sciences and Shadan Institute of Medical Sciences and many affiliated teaching hospitals. The Government Nizamia Tibbi College is a college of Unani medicine. Hyderabad is also the headquarters of the Indian Heart Association, a non- profit foundation for cardiovascular education.

Institutes in Hyderabad include the National Institute of Rural Development, the Indian School of Business, the Institute of Public Enterprise, the Administrative Staff College of India and the Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel National Police Academy. Technical and engineering schools include the International Institute of Information Technology, Hyderabad (IIITH), Birla Institute of Technology and Science, Pilani – Hyderabad (BITS Hyderabad) and Indian Institute of Technology, Hyderabad (IIT-H) as well as agricultural engineering institutes such as the International Crops Research Institute for the Semi-Arid Tropics (ICRISAT) and the Acharya N. G. Ranga Agricultural University.

3. Culture and Tourism:

Hyderabad emerged as the foremost centre of culture in India with the decline of the Mughal Empire. The migration of performing artists to the city particularly from the north and west of the Indian sub-continent, under the patronage of the Nizam, enriched the cultural milieu. This migration resulted in a mingling of North and South Indian languages, cultures and religions, which has since led to a co-existence of Hindu and Muslim traditions, for which the city has become noted. A further consequence of this north-south mix is that both Telugu and Urdu are official languages of Telangana. The mixing of religions has also resulted in many festivals being celebrated in Hyderabad such as Ganesh Chaturthi, Diwali and Bonalu of Hindu tradition and Eid ul-Fitr and Eid al-Adha by Muslims.

The Telugu film industry based in the city is the country's second-largest producer of motion pictures.

The Charminar has come to symbolize Hyderabad. Golconda fort is another major landmark.

Hyderabad was historically known as a pearl and diamond trading centre, and it continues to be known as the City of Pearls. Many of the city's traditional bazaars remain open, including Laad Bazaar, Begum Bazaar and Sultan Bazaar.

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